

FDE FIELD NOTES · ISSUE 07 OF 10

The export is missing a column.

Day-one data reality beats week-three surprises.

07

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Swipe →

Day-one data checks

- ☒ Schema matches what we were told

- ☒ Null rate per column

- ☒ Timezones and daylight saving

- ☒ IDs unique and stable

- ☒ Duplicates and late updates

- ☒ Free text that hides PII

Agree a data contract

- 1 Sample export
- 2 Profile it
- 3 Write expectations
- 4 Validate every load
- 5 Alert the owner

The contract names a human owner on the customer side. A broken load pages them, not you.

Unknowns log

UNKNOWN	OWNER	DUE
Is status column back-filled?	Data lead	Wed
Which TZ are timestamps?	IT	Tue
Can records be deleted?	Legal	Fri
Who fixes the export?	Ops manager	Thu



Leftovers after the pilot

01 Known gaps

Columns we worked around, written down.

02 Manual steps

Anything a human still has to do.

03 Debt with a date

Each leftover has an owner and a deadline.

PRINCIPLE

**Unknowns are fine.
Hidden unknowns are
not.**

Write them down, give each an owner, and show the list in every readout.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Profile the real export before you design anything.

- Run day-one data checks
- Agree a contract with a named owner
- Keep an unknowns log in every readout

YOUR TURN

What is the worst data surprise you found too late?

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Next in the series: #08 Audit logs and the no-write-back rule

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